Solar Power Bank — Customer Research

KEY FINDINGS

1. **Buyers use it for three things:** outdoors (19%), emergencies and outages (13%) and travel (12%). It's a "just in case" product. People buy it before a trip or a storm, then end up using it every day.
2. **Weight is the #1 complaint, not solar.** 13% call it heavy or bulky, and only 6% complain that solar is slow. Most solar complaints come pre-forgiven ("the brand told me it's a backup"). Setting expectations honestly works.
3. **Rugged build is the #1 praise (19%), followed by the flashlight (10%).** People love that it feels tough. "Hefty in a good way" and "survived drops, sand and bags" come up again and again.
4. **The emotional peak is the outage story.** Reviews like "grandma's literal lifeline" and "what a life saver" during snow storms and hurricanes are the most vivid language in the whole set, even though they're a minority of reviews.
5. **Reddit is skeptical of solar power banks,** with comments like "aren't worth crap" and "a waste of time", and suspicious of fake mAh on Amazon. Out of the gate, the market believes the solar is a gimmick, so the honest "backup top-up" framing is the only credible one.
6. **Australian context is present.** Reddit mentions floods, cyclones, bushfires and "power problems up north", plus a warning about a cheap non-Australian-standard device causing a house fire, which makes safety standards an objection for AU buyers.

MAIN AVATAR — "THE READY ONE"

Core desire: "Whatever happens — a storm, a campsite, a long day out — I want to know my phone, and my family's, won't die on me."

Core-5 (Desire → Experience → Emotion → Behaviour → Demographics)

- **Desire:** To be the one who's prepared. Stay reachable, have light, and not be helpless when the power or the plug isn't there.
- **Experience:** Has been caught out before, by a storm outage, a phone dying on a trip, or the kids' phones flat at camp. Owns several power banks already, but the small ones die fast and none of them are where they're needed when it counts.
- **Emotion:** Low-grade "what if" anxiety, then relief and quiet pride when the kit works ("what a life saver"). Mildly frustrated by gadgets that over-promise.

- **Behaviour:** Buys ahead of a known event (storm season, a trip, a festival). Keeps one in the car or kit and buys extras for family. Charges it at the wall and treats solar as a bonus. Reads reviews for real-world numbers.
- **Demographics (hypothesis, to validate):** 30–60, both genders, often the household organiser or the partner who "handles" preparedness. Commonly a parent. Many buy for a partner, parent or grandparent. Middle income; price-aware but will pay for something that feels tough.

Avatar card

- **Name:** The Ready One
- **Age:** 30–60
- **Gender:** Mixed. Women often buy for a husband, partner or family.
- **Marital / kids:** Often partnered with kids ("charged all the kids' phones over the weekend")
- **Occupation:** Varied. Over-index on outdoor and blue-collar workers and people who travel for work.
- **Income:** Middle. On Reddit, a clear budget segment (renters, minimum wage) wants prep under $50–$200.

Core challenges and pain points:

- Phones die at the worst time (outage, campsite, long travel day).
- Small 5,000mAh banks "die way too quickly".
- Cables are forgotten, tangled or wrong.
- Lighting during a blackout is poor.
- Not sure which gadgets actually work.

Goals and values: Self-reliance, looking after family, practicality over looks, gear that survives being thrown around, not wasting money on gimmicks.

Objections and questions: Does the solar actually work? How heavy is it? Is the capacity real? Will wireless work through my case? Is it safe left in a hot car? Will it charge my watch?

Tried and didn't work:

- Small power banks
- Charging in the car or idling the truck
- Candles and $1.50 lanterns
- Generators: fuel, noise and neighbour friction
- Big $500+ power stations: overkill for phones
- Cheap solar gadgets that over-promised

SUB-AVATARS

A. Storm-Season Household ("Storm-Ready")

- **Share:** about 13% of reviews; the dominant theme on Reddit.
- **Desire:** "When the power goes out, I want my family connected, with light, and not panicking."
- **Trigger:** A storm warning, or the memory of the last outage. Buys "just weeks before" or right after one.
- **Language:** "lifeline", "life saver", "got to stay prepared", "hurricanes are an unwanted way of life", "keep on hand and charged up for times when the power goes out"
- **AU translation:** QLD storms, floods, cyclones, bushfire blackouts
- **Where:** r/preppers, local city subs (r/brisbane, r/GoldCoast), storm-season news
- **Ad entry:** Problem aware. Open on the last blackout: phone on 8%, kids in the dark.

B. Weekend Camper / Family Outdoors ("Campsite")

- **Share:** about 19% of reviews, the largest use case.
- **Desire:** "I want the trip to be about the trip, not about whose phone is on 3%."
- **Trigger:** An upcoming trip or festival, or the last trip where everyone's phone died.
- **Language:** "charge all the kids' phones", "held up to a three-week camping trip", "hefty but in an entirely good way", "no more 'anyone have a charger?'"
- **Where:** r/camping, r/CampingandHiking, r/carcamping, r/4x4australia
- **Ad entry:** Solution aware. They own power banks. Show capacity (4 charges), ruggedness and the torch at camp.

C. Traveller / Road-tripper

- **Share:** about 12% of reviews.
- **Desire:** "I never want to be hunting for a powerpoint when I'm away."
- **Use cases:** Disneyland days, international trips, a cross-country motorcycle ride, work travel ("always forget my charger at the hotel").
- **Language:** "helped me in several countries", "still going strong after nearly 4 years", "dropped, lived in sand, tossed in bags"
- **Ad entry:** Product aware. Proof of durability and capacity, plus a carry-on note.

D. Gift Buyer

- **Share:** about 3% explicit, but many reviewers "bought two" or bought "for my husband" or "for grandma". In season now (Christmas).
- **Desire:** "I want to give something they'll actually use, and that keeps them safe."
- **Language:** "This will be everyone's gift next Christmas", "fancy/expensive looking box", "husband's favorite charger", "great gift for anyone who's on the go"

- **Ad entry:** Identity. "For the one who's always prepared", plus gift-ready packaging and a 2-pack.

E. Outdoor Worker / Tradie

- **Share:** about 1% explicit, but the language is the sharpest in the set, and it's a strong AU fit.
- **Desire:** "My phone is my work tool, and it can't die on a 12-hour day."
- **Language:** "I work outside all day, so portable chargers have become my best friends", "works 12-18 hour days on a job that requires him to use his phone for work orders", "Not a want but a need!"
- **Ad entry:** Solution aware. Ruggedness, dust and water resistance, capacity for long days.

F. Budget / Beginner Prepper (Reddit)

- **Who:** Renters on a tight budget who "don't understand the mAh stuff" and are wary of fake-capacity Amazon listings. Prep budgets run from $50 to $200–300.
- **Desire:** "Tell me the simple thing that keeps my phone alive without wasting money."
- **Ad entry:** New information. Plain-English numbers ("20,000mAh = about 4 phone charges"), honest solar claims, real capacity.

Niche notes

Medical-device dependents charge insulin pumps, glucose monitors or hearing aids. They're high stakes, so they want redundancy. Don't make medical claims; at most, say they "keep essentials charged".

Family-abroad buyers buy for relatives facing rolling blackouts in Cuba (in Spanish reviews). This is small and US-centric, so it's not a priority for AU.

CUSTOMER LANGUAGE

Buzzwords to track

- **Preparedness:** prepared, just in case, emergency, power outage, blackout, lifeline, life saver, peace of mind, keep on hand
- **Product feel:** rugged, sturdy, durable, solid, hefty, heavy, bulky, clunky, brick
- **Function:** fast charge, multiple charges, juice, top up, trickle charge, backup, direct sun
- **Use:** camping, hiking, road trip, festival, keep it in my car, everyday

Verbatim phrases (Amazon)

- "This charger became her literal lifeline"
- "what a life saver!"
- "Not a want but a need!"
- "hefty but in an entirely good way"
- "Amazing survival tool you didnt know you needed"
- "It's been dropped, lived in sand, tossed in bags"
- "Got to stay prepared."
- "The solar charge is a good backup"
- "Solar charging is iffy works but take like 4 days"
- "it charges in direct sun- not filtered light!"
- "you might need two, one to use while the second one charges"
- "This will be everyone's gift next Christmas."

Verbatim phrases (Reddit)

- "most of those power banks with a built-in solar charger aren't worth crap"
- "If the price seems too good to be true, it's probably a fake capacity."
- "Im not a tecophile so i dont really understand the mAh stuff"
- "the normal portable phone charges I have seem to die way too quickly"
- "Kept 2 phones charged for a 3 day weekend with plenty of juice to spare."
- "Gotta be prepped for bloody everything." (Australian commenter)
- "it took a hurricane followed by a week without power to convince my husband that my prepping wasn't crazy"

CORE PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS TRIED

Problem 1: The phone dies when the power or the plug isn't there

Solutions tried:

- Small power banks ("die way too quickly")
- Car charging or idling the truck
- Airplane mode and rationing the phone
- Borrowing a neighbour's generator, which caused resentment
- Big power stations ($500+, overkill)

Problem 2: No light in a blackout

Solutions tried:

- Candles (soot, fire risk)
- $1.50 lanterns
- Flashlights that "are absolutely useless at lighting up an entire room"
- Headlamps

Problem 3: Not trusting the gear

- Fake mAh claims
- Solar banks that don't charge from the sun
- Cheap devices failing or catching fire

Problem 4: Cable chaos

- Forgetting, tangling or carrying the wrong cable. Built-in cables are praised for exactly this.

Other problems: Weight in a day bag, wireless that won't work through a thick case, short included cables.

GOOD AND BAD COMPARATIVE REVIEWS

Good (vs other banks they own):

- Charges faster than other bricks
- Used more than their Anker
- Wireless and wired at the same time
- Tough corners survive drops
- Customer service replaced faulty units quickly (5% mention service)

Bad:

- Heavy or bulky (13%)
- Solar is slow, takes days from empty and needs direct sun, not a window (6%)
- Wireless needs the case removed and is "spot specific" (4%)
- Compass is a "gimmick" or inaccurate
- Ports or units failed (4%)
- Watch charger works with Apple Watch only
- Warping or overheating if left on a hot dashboard

OBJECTIONS AND FAQ

- **"Does the solar actually work?"** → Yes, as a top-up in direct sun. Charge it at the wall first, and the sun keeps it topped up. Expect days, not hours, from empty.
- **"Why won't it charge on my windowsill?"** → It needs direct sunlight outside. Glass and indoor light give almost nothing.
- **"Is it heavy?"** → Be upfront about the weight (around 470g packed). It's a car, kit or bag item, not a pocket item.
- **"Is the capacity real?"** → Publish tested capacity and real phone-charge counts.
- **"Will wireless work through my case?"** → Thin cases yes; thick or rugged cases may need removing. Use USB-C for speed.
- **"Can I leave it in the car?"** → Glovebox or shade, yes. On a hot dashboard, no, because heat damages lithium batteries.
- **"Can I charge the bank and my phone at the same time?"** → Answer from supplier testing.
- **"Can I fly with it?"** → Carry-on only (about 74Wh); check your airline.
- **"Is it safe and certified for Australia?"** → List the certifications. This matters to AU buyers who've seen cheap-device fire stories.
- **"Will it charge my watch?"** → Only if your model has a watch pad and your watch supports it. Be specific.

BELIEFS AND AWARENESS

Core beliefs of the market

1. "Being prepared is responsible, not crazy." Preppers often feel judged until the outage proves them right.
2. "Most gadgets on Amazon over-promise."
3. "Solar on a power bank is mostly a gimmick."
4. "Tough and heavy means quality; flimsy means it'll fail when I need it."
5. "My phone is my lifeline. In a crisis, the first thing to go is information."
6. "Charge at the wall; anything else is a bonus."

Awareness

This is a **trigger-moment market**. Most buyers sit at solution aware (they own power banks) until a storm warning, an outage or a trip booking moves them to buy fast. Ads should either recreate the trigger moment (an outage, a dead phone at camp) or ride a real one (storm season, Christmas, summer holidays).

TOP REVIEWS BY SUB-AVATAR

Internal research only. These are BLAVOR's Amazon reviews and can't be used as social proof for our product (misattributed testimonials breach ACL and Meta policy). Use them for angles, hooks and script language.

A. Storm-Season Household

1. ★5 — "I bought this solar charger as a birthday gift for my grandma in Texas, coincidentally just weeks before the historic winter storm that knocked out her power for over a week. This charger became her literal lifeline to keep her essentials charged."
2. ★5 — "I ordered and received it couple weeks prior to these past snow storms here in San Antonio, TX and what a life saver! It was fully charged as the power outage came and I used it to keep my phone charged and light at night."
3. ★5 — "I needed this for hurricanes and I love it! Will buy as gifts for family members too... Just don't forget, it needs sunlight to charge."
4. ★5 — "Came in very handy got this yesterday power went out shortly after... living in Florida you have to be ready for hurricane season... Plan to get another for my car. Got to stay prepared."
5. ★4 — "I ordered this power supply for camping but so far it came in handy when we got hit with hurricane Helene. We were without power for a day."

B. Weekend Camper / Family Outdoors

1. ★5 — "This is a massive capacity battery that let me charge up all the kids' phones with room to spare over the entire weekend."
2. ★4 — "Held up to a three-week camping trip. Charges well in direct sunlight."
3. ★5 — "It is hefty but in an entirely good way as you don't want to haul around a flimsy device outdoors."
4. ★5 — "I bought this solar power bank primarily for my camping trips, and it has exceeded my expectations... An essential accessory if you spend a lot of time outdoors or want to be prepared for any power outage."
5. ★5 — "My husband... had no problem using it at the campground. He just left it outside his tent to charge up."

C. Traveller / Road-tripper

1. ★5 — "I've taken it camping, on airplanes, all over Disneyland (multiple trips)... It's been dropped, lived in sand, tossed in bags, and generally not babied. It keeps going."
2. ★5 — "This product has helped me in several countries & even during power outages back in the US."
3. ★5 — "I bought two of these items for a cross-country motorcycle trip... Charged my motorcycle helmet and iPhone several times before I needed to charge it."
4. ★5 — "I travel for work and i always forget my charger at the hotel. Glad i bought this."
5. ★5 — "Can charge my samsung s7 and my sisters iphone se at 100% for the duration of a 14 hour trip watching videos."

D. Gift Buyer

1. ★5 — "I always pick one thing to give my family for Christmas that I have 5 stars to. This will be everyone's gift next Christmas."
2. ★5 — "This product came in a fancy/expensive looking box, which will make a great looking Gift."
3. ★5 — "My husband uses this thing everyday." (Husbands favorite charger)
4. ★5 — "Great gift for anyone who's on the go, adventuring, or constantly runs their phone down."
5. ★5 — "This would make a nice little gift for anyone or as a gift for yourself."

E. Outdoor Worker / Tradie

1. ★5 — "My boyfriend has ruined the charging port of every phone he's ever had. He's blue collar... works 12-18 hour days on a job that requires him to use his phone for work orders and directions."
2. ★5 — "I work outside all day, so portable chargers have become my best friends."
3. ★4 — "The solar charge is a good backup but would not want to count on this as the sole means of re-charging... in fairness Blavor states this very clearly."

4. ★5 — "I leave this in my car and the sun hits it to charge it up. Super slow sun charger but i hardly use it for it to matter."

ANGLE STARTERS

- **A — "The blackout test":** last storm, phone on 8%, torch on, kids calm. Hook: "The night the power went out, I was the only one with a charged phone."
- **B — "Whose phone is on 3%?":** campsite group chaos, then one rugged bank charges everyone.
- **C — "Dropped, sanded, still going":** a durability torture test in travel montage.
- **D — "The gift they'll actually use":** for the dad, partner or grandparent who's "always prepared". 2-pack: one for the car, one for home.
- **E — "My phone is my work":** tradie on a 12-hour day, dust, rain, still charged.
- **F — "The honest solar power bank":** "Most solar power banks lie. Here's what ours actually does."